

## Informational Text • Informational

|              |                |             |                            |
|--------------|----------------|-------------|----------------------------|
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| Learning A–Z | level <b>H</b> |             |                            |

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. was one of the most influential civil rights leaders in American history. He worked hard for equality and taught others how to stand up for what they believed in by using peaceful ways to resist violence.

**Dr. King's Memorial** provides an introduction to Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.'s work and his role in changing unfair laws against racism.

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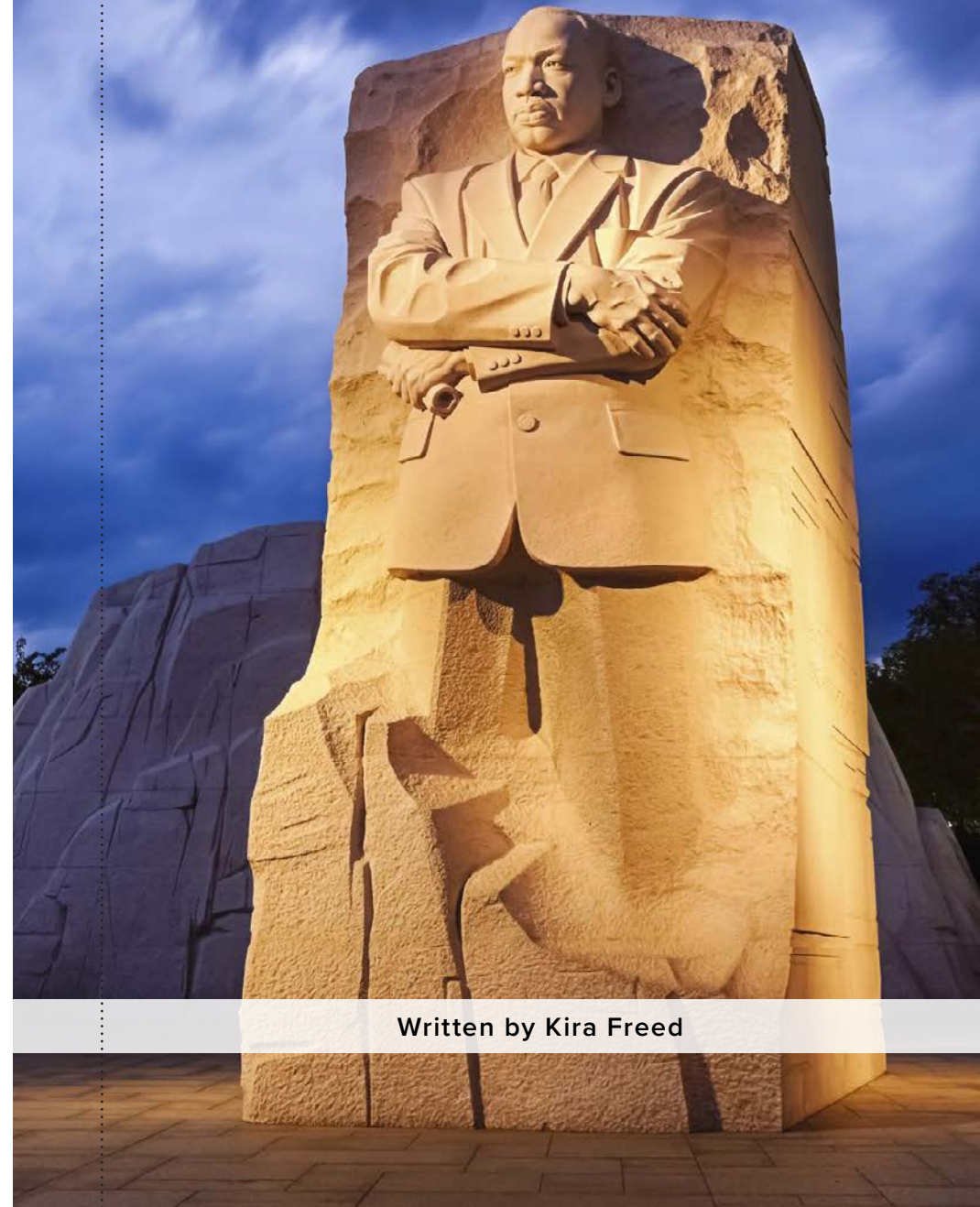
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# Dr. King's Memorial



Written by Kira Freed

# Dr. King's Memorial

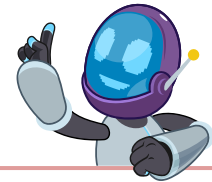


Above: Dr. King with his wife and children in 1966

Written by Kira Freed

## Focus Question

Who was Dr. King, and why is he important?



## Words to Know

fair

memorial

laws

peaceful

marched

separate

## Connections

### Writing and Art

Write a paragraph about why it was important for Dr. King to make changes in a peaceful way.

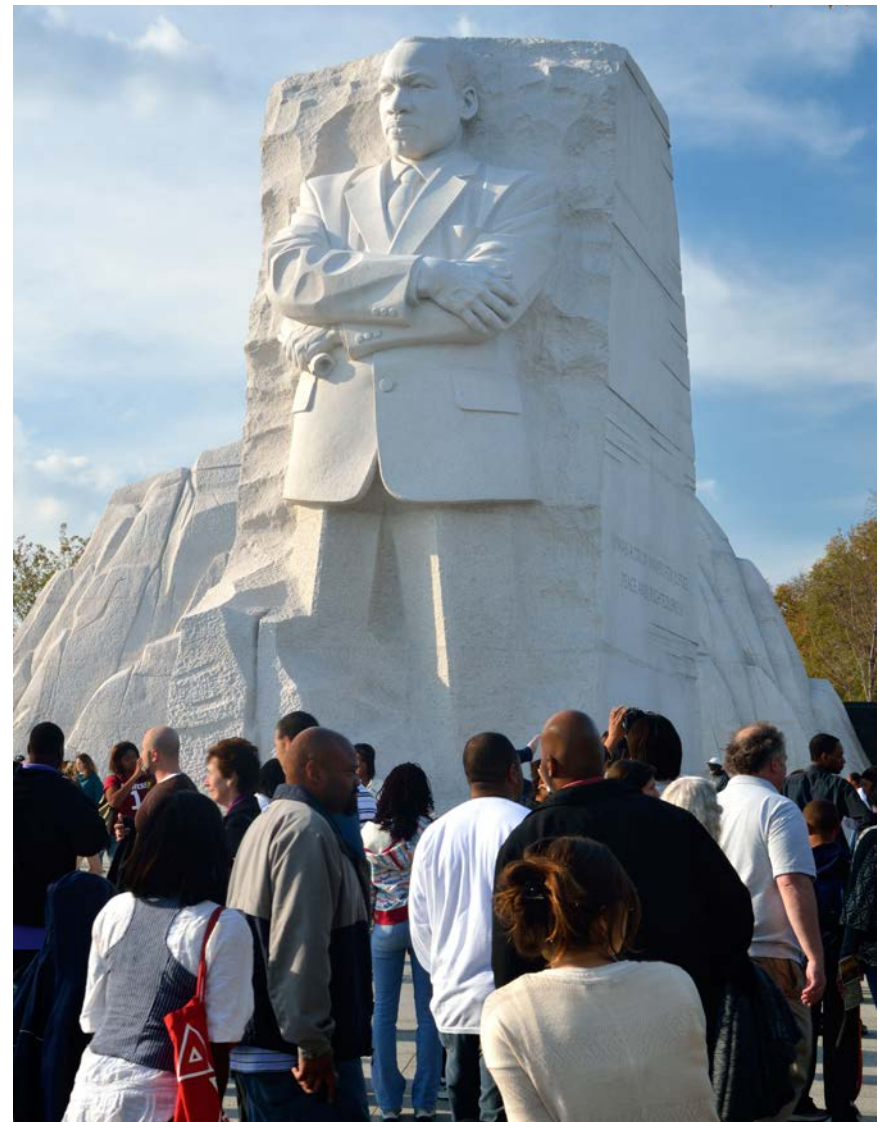
### Social Studies

Learn more about Dr. King's life. Make a timeline that includes five important events from his life.



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The Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Memorial

## Introduction

A **memorial** to Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. is in Washington, D.C.



“The time is always right  
to do what is right.”  
—Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

Many people watch as Dr. King gives a speech about equality.

Who was Dr. King?

Why do we remember him?

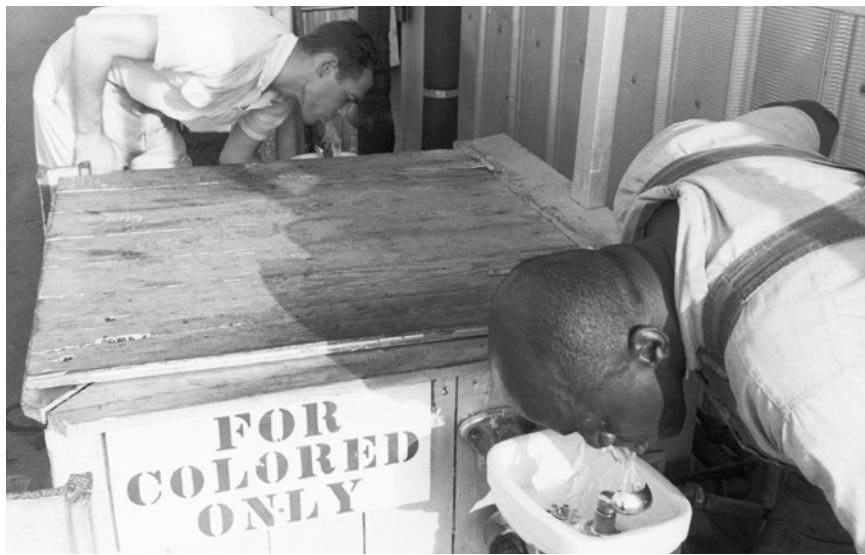


A young Martin Luther King Jr. (front, right) is shown with his family.

## The South

Dr. King grew up in the South  
in the 1930s.

Many **laws** in the South at that time  
were not **fair** to Black people.



Men drink from water fountains marked “Colored.” Today, this term is considered rude and can be hurtful.

Laws kept Black people and white people **separate**.  
White children and Black children went to different schools.



Black people sit at the back of a bus.

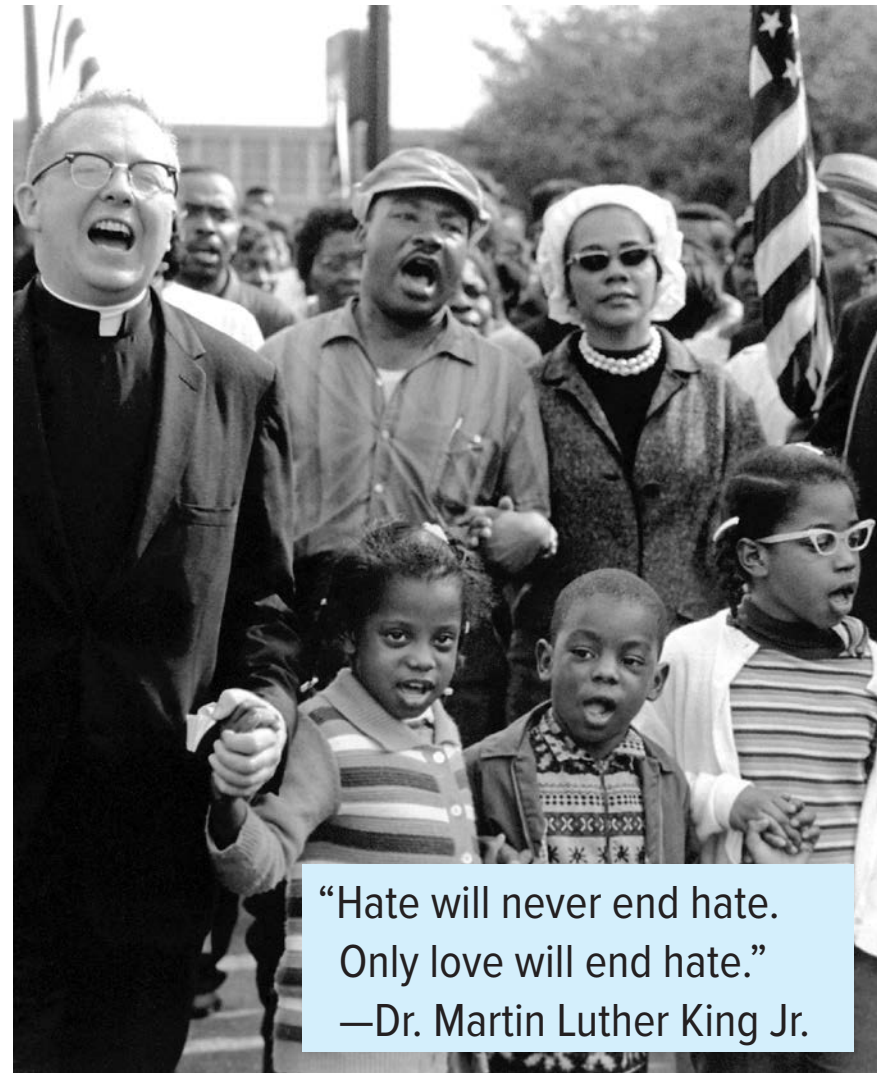
Black people had to sit at the backs of city buses.  
The front seats were for white people.



Dr. King talks to people about unfair laws.

## Dr. King's Work

Dr. King wanted the unfair laws to change.  
He talked to many people about how to change the laws.



"Hate will never end hate.  
Only love will end hate."  
—Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

Dr. King wanted to use **peaceful** ways to make changes.  
He said there was already too much hate in the world.



Dr. King leads a march to change the unfair laws.

Dr. King **marched** with many people.  
 They marched to say no  
 to unfair laws.  
 Dr. King worked with many people  
 to get the laws changed.



Dr. King shakes hands with President Lyndon Johnson in 1964.  
 President Johnson signed a bill that changed the unfair laws.

## New Laws

The laws changed in 1964.  
 The new laws are fairer.  
 It is now against the law  
 to treat people unfairly  
 because of their skin color.



Two Black girls go to a school that used to be for white children only.

Black children and white children  
can go to the same schools.  
People of every color can sit where  
they want on buses.

## Do You Know?

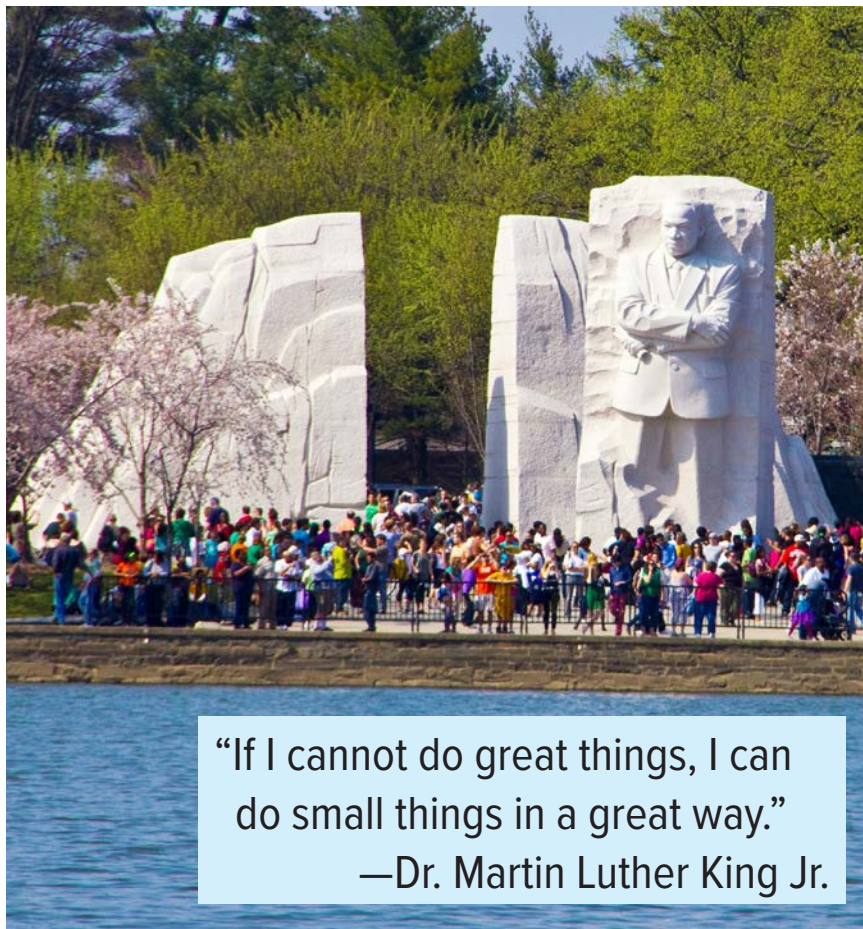
Rosa Parks would not sit at the back of a bus in 1955. Her courage helped change the unfair laws.



Dr. King waves to the crowd in Washington, D.C., before he gives an important speech.

## Dr. King's Dream

Dr. King wanted all people to be free.  
He wanted the laws to be fair  
for everyone.  
He dreamed that people of every  
color would get along.



People remember Dr. King  
when they visit the memorial  
in Washington, D.C.  
They remember his dream  
of fair laws and free people.  
They carry on Dr. King’s work.

## Glossary

**fair** (*adj.*) page 6

just, right, or proper

**laws** (*n.*) page 6

rules made by a government

**marched** (*v.*) page 11

walked with other people to show  
support

**memorial** (*n.*) page 4

something that stands for the  
memory of a person, place, thing,  
or event

**peaceful** (*adj.*) page 10

without fighting

**separate** (*adj.*) page 7

set or kept apart